FREE EXECUTIVE RESOURCE

# The 25-Point Produce Business Health Checklist

Adezmold Business Consulting | 0703 524 6809

Find where money slips away between buying, transport, storage and sales collections, before your next shipment.

### HOW TO USE THIS CHECKLIST

1. Go through each check honestly. Tick the box only if it is true in your business today, not "most of the time".
2. Involve the person who handles cash and the person who handles stock. Their answers often differ from the owner's.
3. Count your ticks at the end and look first at the sections with the most empty boxes.

## CASH AND BANK MANAGEMENT

4 checks

- ☐ 01 Every sale is recorded on the day it happens, including cash sales.
- ☐ 02 Cash on hand is counted and agreed to the sales record at each day's close.
- ☐ 03 Business money and personal money are kept in separate accounts.
- ☐ 04 Bank statements are reconciled to your records at least once a month.

## STOCK CONTROL AND STOCK LOSSES

4 checks

- ☐ 05 Every delivery is weighed or counted on arrival and recorded against its waybill.
- ☐ 06 Differences between quantities dispatched and quantities received are recorded and explained.
- ☐ 07 Physical stock is counted at least monthly and compared with the stock record.
- ☐ 08 Spoiled, damaged or downgraded stock is recorded with the reason and who approved it.

## DEBTORS AND CREDITORS

3 checks

- ☐ 09 Each credit customer has an agreed credit limit and payment period.
- ☐ 10 You keep an up-to-date list of who owes you, how much, and for how long.

- [ ] **11** You know exactly what you owe each supplier and when it falls due.

## SALES AND PURCHASING RECORDS

3 checks

- [ ] **12** Each sale has a receipt or invoice showing date, quantity, price and buyer.
- [ ] **13** Each purchase is supported by a receipt, waybill or supplier invoice.
- [ ] **14** Unit prices paid and received are recorded so you can compare them over time.

## GROSS PROFIT AND OPERATING COSTS

3 checks

- [ ] **15** You know your gross profit for each product line, not only total sales.
- [ ] **16** Transport, loading, storage and market levies are recorded as separate costs.
- [ ] **17** You compare each month’s costs and margins with previous months.

## STAFF RESPONSIBILITIES AND OPERATING PROCEDURES

3 checks

- [ ] **18** Each staff member has written duties, including who handles cash and who handles stock.
- [ ] **19** No one person both receives stock and records it without a second check.
- [ ] **20** Key routines (intake, dispatch, daily cash close) are written down so others can follow them.

## BUSINESS DOCUMENTATION AND COMPLIANCE READINESS

3 checks

- [ ] **21** Business registration documents are current and easy to find.
- [ ] **22** Receipts, invoices and waybills are filed and kept for a defined period.
- [ ] **23** You know which taxes and levies apply to your business and keep records that support them.

## MANAGEMENT REPORTING

2 checks

- [ ] **24** You review a simple monthly summary of sales, costs, profit, debtors and stock.
- [ ] **25** Within one day, you can tell how much cash, stock and money owed to you the business has.

## YOUR SCORE

### Boxes ticked: _____ out of 25

A rough guide, not a grade: fewer ticks means more places where cash, stock or credit can leak without anyone noticing. Start with the section that has the most empty boxes.

### Want a second pair of eyes on your answers?

Book a confidential discovery session with Adezmold. We will look at where control is slipping and what to fix first.

**Call 0703 524 6809**

This checklist is general educational guidance to help you review your own business. It is not an audit, a certification, or legal, tax or accounting advice, and it does not replace advice on your specific circumstances.